

SOUND AND THE SACRED

FINAL PROJECT PROPOSAL

Length: 250 words

Due: Friday, October 10, 2025

ASSIGNMENT

For your final project, you will select and analyze an example of religious sound, broadly defined, within a broader religio-cultural context largely unfamiliar to you. You may choose publicly available recordings, religious sound represented by a score (notated or graphic), or your own field recordings from a public event. Your project will be prepared as a page on our Canvas site for other students to view, and will minimally consist of the following components:

- Broad sociocultural context
- Embedded media (notated or graphic score, audiovisual clip, field recording, playlist, etc.)
- Sonic analysis
- Religious and/or spiritual significance
- Further reading/listening/viewing (not included in length requirement)

In total, the final project should be 1500–2000 words in length (equivalent of approximately 6–8 double-spaced pages). You will develop this project in iterative stages with input from me at regular intervals. This final project proposal identifies the religious sound example you intend to analyze and contextualize for the project. It should include the following components:

- What is the religious sound example you are planning to research? Please provide a link to any extant media, if available.
- What about this religious sound example is attractive or interesting to you?
- What is the broader religio-cultural context of this religious sound? Include as much detail as you can: faith tradition, geographic region, cultural group, historical era, etc.
- To the best of your knowledge, how does this example of religious sound function within its broader religio-context?

SUBMISSION AND FORMAT

Upload your assignment to Canvas by 11:59 p.m. on Friday, October 10. See the syllabus for late assignment penalties. Save assignments in Microsoft Word (.doc/.docx) or rich text file (.rtf) format. All quotes and references must be properly cited; follow any style guide with which you are familiar as long as you are consistent. [Email me](#) or [schedule an appointment](#) to discuss any questions you have about the assignment.

The final project is cumulatively worth 25% of your final grade.